WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

MAURITIUS

Africa

Information current as of October 2026

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office@lordwaverley.com
www.lordwaverley.com

WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Port Louis	Capital, seat of government and principal commercial centre, home to the country's main port and Freeport zone	Financial services, trade, port logistics, administration
Ebène CyberCity	Leading business district for banks, global business companies, management firms and ICT operators serving Africa-focused investment	Financial services, wealth management, ICT, business process services
Port Louis Harbour and Freeport	Customs-free re-export zone of over 550,000 sq m, with a $58 million container-terminal equipment programme and a strategic operating partnership under negotiation	Logistics, warehousing, re-export, bunkering
Smart City and AI City developments	Mixed-use projects under EDB schemes offering incentives and residency routes, now joined by a new AI City Scheme for technology investors	Real estate, technology, education, healthcare
Coastal tourism belts (north, east and west coasts)	Core of a tourism sector that welcomed a record 1.44 million visitors in 2025, with India and southern Europe the fastest-growing markets	Hotels, hospitality, leisure property, aviation
Nationwide solar-and-storage sites	220 MW tender across 13 locations launched in 2026 as part of a 405 MW renewable pipeline supporting a 60% renewable-electricity target for 2030	Solar power, battery storage, grid services
Maritime zone and outer islands	Extensive ocean territory underpinning the government's Blue Economy priority sector	Fisheries, aquaculture, marine services, ocean research

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Economic Development Board (EDB), the single government gateway for investment promotion, permits and incentives under the EDB Act 2017, including the Premium Investor Certificate for projects of at least Rs 500 million
- Open company regime permitting 100% foreign ownership with no minimum capital, a corporate tax rate of 15% or lower, 46 investment promotion and protection agreements (30 in force) and arbitration through the Mauritius International Arbitration Centre

- Financial Services Commission licensing for global business, funds and wealth management; Mauritius left the FATF grey list in October 2021 and the EU high-risk list in January 2022
- Freeport regime offering a 3% corporate tax rate, an eight-year income tax holiday for qualifying investments and duty and VAT exemptions for re-export activity
- No exchange controls: profits, dividends and capital can be freely repatriated, with no tax on dividends or capital gains, under the Bank of Mauritius's IMF Article VIII commitments
- Property and residency routes, including EDB property schemes from $375,000 and a new golden visa granting 20-year permanent residence for investments of at least $1 million
- Sector-entry through competitive tenders and strategic partnerships, such as the 220 MW solar-and-storage programme and port modernisation

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Mauritius in October 2026 combines an investment-grade credit rating, high income per capita and deep financial buffers with a well-established role as a gateway between Africa, Asia and Europe. Statistics Mauritius estimates that GDP grew 3.5% in 2025 and projects 3.0% growth in 2026, with finance and insurance, trade and transport leading. Foreign direct investment (excluding global business companies) rose 45.6% to Rs 48.0 billion in 2025, led by real estate and a sharp rise in financial-sector inflows, mainly from the UK and France. Tourism reached a record 1.44 million visitors, occupation permit applications have nearly tripled since 2018 to 10,550, and the extension of AGOA to the end of 2028 has restored duty-free US access for exporters. The 2026–27 Budget added an AI City Scheme and a golden visa, and the EDB is targeting Rs 38–40 billion of FDI in the current fiscal year.

Mauritius's main structural task is to rebuild fiscal space while sustaining growth. Public debt stood at about 87.8% of GDP in mid-2026, above the authorities' 80% anchor, but consolidation is clearly under way: the deficit fell from 9.3% of GDP in FY2024/25 to about 6.0% in FY2025/26 and is targeted at 3.7% in FY2026/27, progress that Moody's has acknowledged while keeping a Baa3 rating with a negative outlook. Imported energy costs lifted inflation to 5.7% in September 2026, and the Bank of Mauritius has responded early, raising its Key Rate to 4.75% in May. Gross official reserves of $10.2 billion, equivalent to 14.4 months of imports, a large positive net international investment position and a well-capitalised banking sector give the economy a substantial cushion. The government's plans to double capital spending, partner with the private sector on the port and expand renewable power create direct openings for investors.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Elevated public debt	Public debt of about 87.8% of GDP sits above the 80% anchor, and the sovereign carries negative outlooks from Moody's (Baa3) and CareEdge (BBB)	Deficit reduction from 9.3% to a targeted 3.7% of GDP in two years is on track; investors can monitor fiscal milestones while benefiting from investment-grade status
Imported inflation and energy costs	Inflation rose to 5.7% in September 2026 as fuel and food prices increased, above the central bank's 2–5% target range	Early monetary tightening is anchoring expectations, and energy import dependence is driving a sizeable solar-and-storage investment pipeline
Chagos treaty ratification	UK ratification of the 2025 treaty has been on hold since early 2026 pending discussions with the US, and the Budget assumes treaty revenue of about Rs 10.6 billion	The matter does not restrict commercial investment; rating agencies already exclude the revenue, so ratification would be upside to the fiscal outlook
Port capacity and efficiency	Exporters and the Chamber of Commerce raised container delivery delays at Port Louis in 2025	New cranes from 2028 and a management partnership with Maersk in its final phase open opportunities in logistics and port services
Governance and transparency	Recent corruption investigations, including into the Mauritius Investment Corporation, show scope to strengthen accountability	Use the EDB's facilitation channels, robust due diligence and Mauritius's internationally recognised arbitration framework
Changing tax and permit rules	The 2026–27 Budget raised some taxes	Engage the EDB and tax advisers early; a

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	and levies and tightened occupation permit criteria, while non-citizen property purchases still require approval	forthcoming Business Facilitation Bill with a silent-agreement principle should speed approvals
Small domestic market and climate exposure	A population of about 1.3 million limits local demand, and the IMF notes medium-term climate and demographic pressures	Use Mauritius as a regional platform with preferential access covering 68% of the world's population, and invest in climate-resilient infrastructure

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Mauritius's risk profile is that of a stable, well-governed democracy with strong institutions, high data transparency and an investment-grade rating, working through a period of fiscal consolidation. The sharp narrowing of the deficit since FY2024/25, early action by the Bank of Mauritius on inflation and reserves equal to more than a year of imports demonstrate policy credibility and resilience to external shocks. The main points to monitor are progress towards the 80% debt anchor, the pace of energy-driven inflation, and the timing of UK ratification of the Chagos treaty, which affects projected public revenue but not the commercial operating environment. The open capital account, full foreign ownership, investment treaty protection and established arbitration options give investors a predictable framework. Investors should allow for adjustments to tax and permit rules as the government balances revenue needs with competitiveness, and should use the EDB as a first point of contact.

MARKET ACCESS

Mauritius is a member of the Southern African Development Community (SADC) and the Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa (COMESA), a signatory to the COMESA–EAC–SADC Tripartite Free Trade Area and a participant in the African Continental Free Trade Area since January 2021, and a founding member of the WTO. It has free trade agreements with China (in force January 2021) and India (CECPA, April 2021), an interim Economic Partnership Agreement with the EU and an Economic Partnership Agreement with the UK, and AGOA preferences for US-bound goods now run to the end of 2028. The United States takes about 11% of goods exports, and Europe supplied 64% of tourist arrivals in early 2026. With preferential access to markets covering 68% of the world's population and an expanding regional outreach to East Africa, Mauritius serves as a platform for structuring and serving investment across Africa and the Indian Ocean.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Prime Minister's Office (Dr Navin Ramgoolam)	Sets economic policy and leads on fiscal consolidation, the Chagos treaty and major reforms	Primary reference point for Mauritius's strategic direction and investment priorities
Economic Development Board (EDB)	Single gateway for investment promotion, investor permits, the Premium Investor Certificate and the new AI City Scheme	Standard first point of contact for market entry, incentives and project facilitation
Bank of Mauritius (Governor Dr Priscilla Muthoora Thakoor)	Sets the Key Rate, manages reserves and supervises banks	Relevant for monetary outlook, currency and banking-sector matters
Ministry of Finance, Economic Planning and Development	Leads the budget, tax policy and the debt-reduction path towards the statutory targets	Key counterpart for fiscal incentives, public investment and PPP opportunities
Financial Services Commission (FSC)	Integrated regulator for non-bank financial services and global business licensing	Essential for structuring funds, holding companies and wealth-management vehicles
Mauritius Ports Authority and Cargo Handling Corporation	Own and operate Port Louis Harbour and its container terminal, now being modernised with a strategic partner	Counterparts for logistics, Freeport and port-services investment
Mauritius International Arbitration Centre (MIAC)	Independent arbitral institution with an ICSID cooperation agreement allowing	Preferred venue for resolving Africa-related commercial and investment

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
	ICSID hearings in Mauritius	disputes

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Mauritius Chamber of Commerce and Industry (MCCI) and Business Mauritius are the main private-sector bodies, alongside sector groups such as the Mauritius Export Association. The EDB leads investor outreach, including business missions to Ethiopia, Tanzania and Kenya in September 2026, participation in the US-Africa Business Summit in December 2026 and preparations for the 2027 EU-Africa Summit, and is launching an E-Diaspora Platform to connect Mauritian professionals abroad. The IMF, World Bank and African Development Bank remain engaged on fiscal reform, infrastructure and climate resilience, while the Ebène financial community of banks, management companies and law firms is a ready source of practical market intelligence on Africa-focused structuring.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Mauritius suits investors seeking a stable, well-regulated base for regional and Africa-focused business: financial-services, fund and wealth-management firms using the FSC framework and treaty network; real estate and hospitality investors building on record tourism and EDB property schemes; technology and AI investors attracted by the new AI City Scheme and golden visa; renewable energy developers bidding into the solar-and-storage pipeline; and logistics, Blue Economy and high-tech manufacturing investors using the Freeport and renewed AGOA access. Healthcare, life sciences and agri-business are further EDB priorities with active project facilitation.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage the Economic Development Board early
Use the EDB to confirm incentives, permits and eligibility for the Premium Investor Certificate, AI City Scheme or property and residency routes.

STEP 2: Structure through the Financial Services Commission framework
Assess FSC licensing options and the investment treaty network for funds, holding companies and regional investment vehicles.

STEP 3: Build the latest tax and permit changes into planning
Review the 2026–27 Budget measures and revised occupation permit rules with local advisers before committing capital.

STEP 4: Track fiscal milestones and the Chagos timeline
Monitor deficit outturns, rating reviews and UK ratification, which could improve the fiscal outlook and support sovereign upgrades.

STEP 5: Target tenders and partnerships in energy, ports and the Blue Economy
Follow the solar-and-storage programme, port modernisation and Freeport opportunities, where public priorities and private capital align.